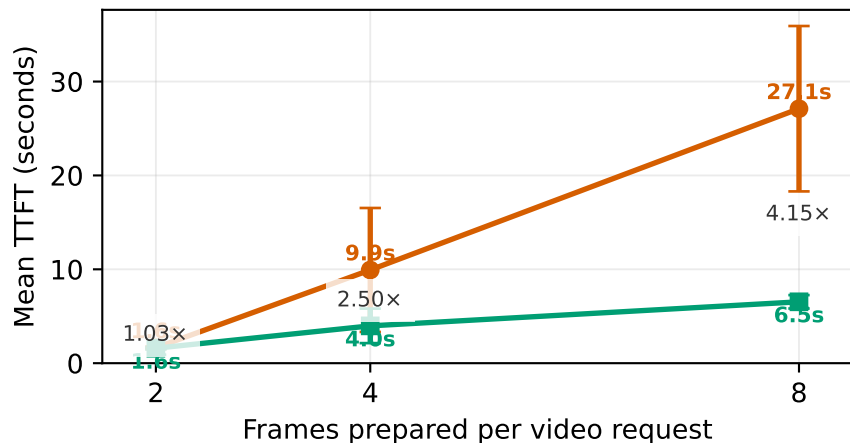


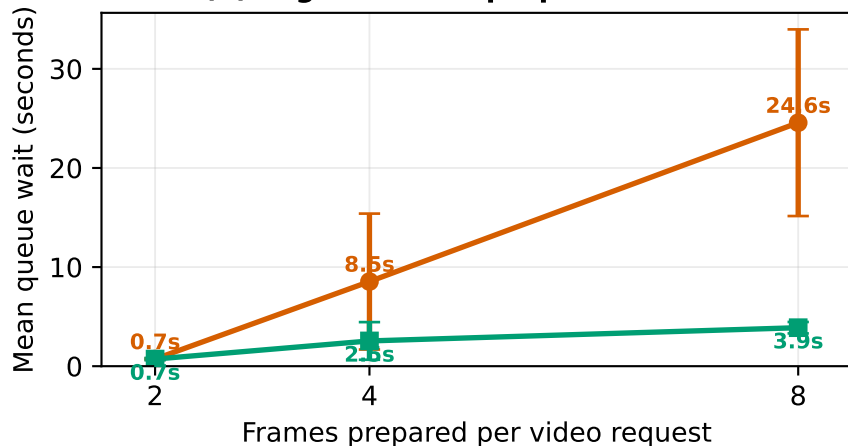
Priority benefit emerges when media preparation becomes congested

Engine-only priority End-to-end priority

(a) Urgent end-to-end TTFT



(b) Urgent media-preparation wait



Burst workload: 64 background + 16 urgent requests; 4 preparation workers; 3 matched seeds per point. Error bars are 95% confidence intervals.